



Vision Document

for

UniHaven

Version 2.0.0

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May 4, 2025

Table of Contents

1. Business Requirements	1
1.1 Background	1
1.2 Business Opportunity	1
1.3 Vision Statement	1
1.4 Business Assumptions and Dependencies	2
2. Scope and Limitations	2
2.1 Major Features	2
2.2 Limitations and Exclusions	3
3. Stakeholders	3
3.1 Stakeholder Profiles	3
4. Delivery	4
4.1 Product Roadmap	4
4.2 Release Plan	4

Revision History

Name	Date	Reason For Changes	Version
Yuxian LI, Lei Yiu Long	19/3/25	baselined following inception and updates, release 1	1.0.0
WEI Ke	4/5/2025	scope extended to cover all members of HKU, HKUST, CUHK, release 2	2.0.0

1. Business Requirements

1.1 Background

Non-local undergraduate and postgraduate students at universities worldwide consistently report difficulties finding suitable off-campus accommodation. At The University of Hong Kong (HKU), Student accommodation service CEDARS provides only basic listing information without verification processes or reservation systems. Students face challenges with unfamiliar rental markets, language barriers, and limited time to search while focusing on academics. The current CEDARS Accommodation Service offers minimal support, posting unverified listings and providing basic online viewing, but lacks comprehensive search, verification, or reservation capabilities. Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST) and The Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK) also face the same problem.

1.2 Business Opportunity

UniHaven addresses this gap by providing a specialized platform connecting universities, students, and verified property owners. The platform will generate revenue through commissions on successful rental contracts. The first release will serve HKU through CEDARS and the second release will serve HKUST and CUHK through their student accommodation services, with planned expansion to other Hong Kong universities and potential global scaling in the future.

The market opportunity is significant due to:

- Growing numbers of international and exchange students at Hong Kong universities
- Limited on-campus housing capacity
- Increasing demand for verified, university-approved housing options

UniHaven delivers value to all stakeholders:

- Universities: Enhanced student services without infrastructure investment
- Students: Access to verified accommodation options with university oversight
- Property owners: Connection to reliable student tenants

1.3 Vision Statement

For non-local students who struggle to find suitable off-campus accommodation, UniHaven is a web-based platform that connects students with verified housing options through university integration.

Unlike current manual support finding processes of student accommodation services, UniHaven provides an End-to-end service with property verification, advanced search capabilities, and reservation management, Streamlining how students secure housing while studying in Hong Kong.

1.4 Business Assumptions and Dependencies

AS-1: Universities are willing to integrate external housing services into their student resource systems.

AS-2: Property owners will accept university verification processes.

AS-3: Students will prefer university-verified accommodations over unverified alternatives.

DE-1: Address Lookup Service for location data and distance calculations.

DE-2: University staff for property verification and contract facilitation.

DE-3: University authentication systems for staff and student access.

2. Scope and Limitations

2.1 Major Features

FE-1: Create and update accommodation listings and details, including property type, availability period, number of beds and bedrooms, price, address, and availability status (University Accommodation Specialists only).

FE-2: Search, filter and view accommodations based on type, price, availability period, size, and proximity to university locations or selected premises.

FE-3: Calculate and display distances between properties and university locations or selected premises using the Address Lookup Service.

FE-4: Reserve properties, track reservation status, and manage cancellations.

FE-5: Alert relevant parties about new reservations, cancellations, and status changes.

FE-6: Allow students to evaluate accommodations after their tenancy period.

FE-7: API endpoints for authentication, property data, and reservation management.

FE-8: Include the other two universities, HKUST and CUHK, to the Unihaven system.

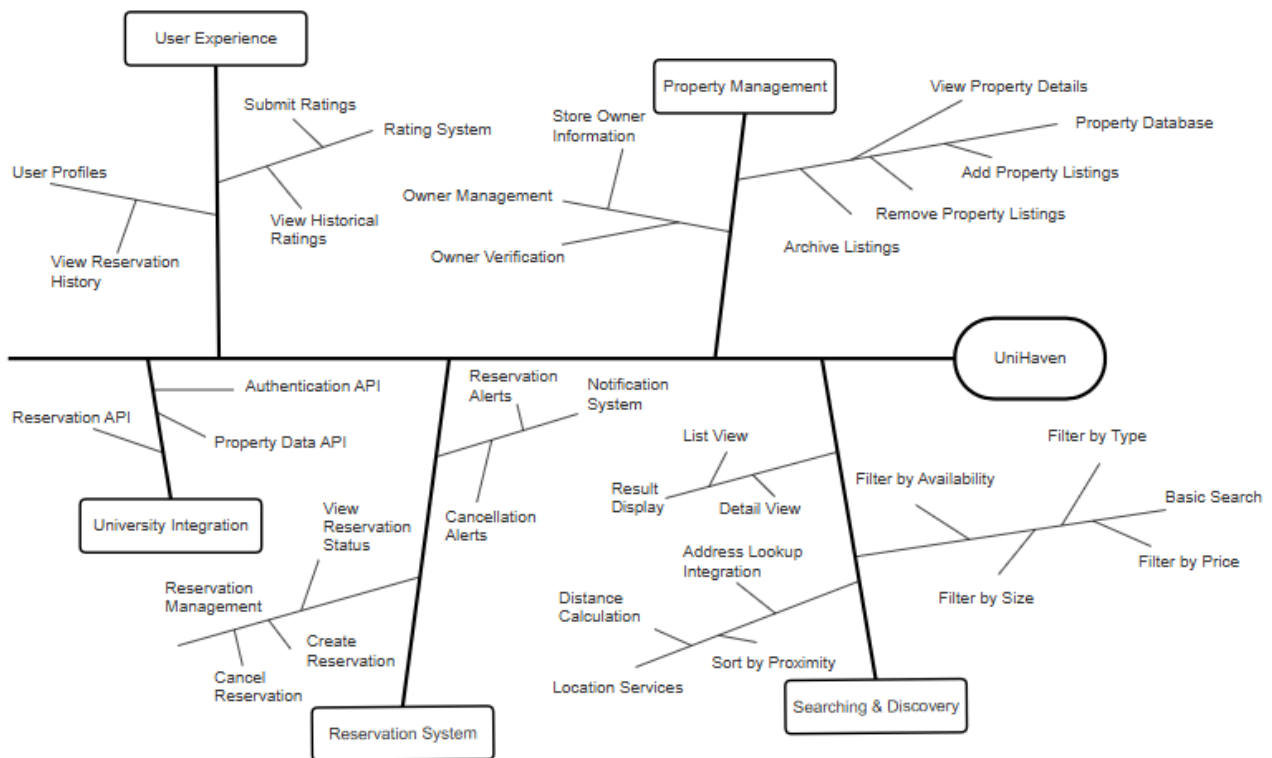


Figure 1. Feature tree for the UniHaven.

2.2 Limitations and Exclusions

LI-1: No direct payment processing within the platform; all financial transactions occur outside the system.

LI-2: No direct messaging between students and property owners; all communication is facilitated by university staff.

LI-3: No mobile application in initial release; access is web-based only.

LI-4: No automatic property verification process; verification requires physical inspection by university staff.

3. Stakeholders

3.1 Stakeholder Profiles

Stakeholder	Major Value	Major Interests
University Students	access to verified accommodation options; simplified search process; confidence in university-approved listings	search functionality; property details; reservation system; ratings from previous tenants

Accommodation Specialists	Streamlined workflow for managing property listings; notification system for reservations	Property management system; notification system; reservation tracking
Property Owners	Access to student tenant market; university verification lending credibility	Property listing capabilities;
UniHaven Company	Commission revenue from successful rentals; expandable business model	All system functionality; API for university integration
Universities	Enhanced student services without infrastructure investment; improved student satisfaction	Integration capabilities; administration dashboard;

4. Delivery

4.1 Product Roadmap

Feature	Release 1	Release 2
Target	04/2025	05/2025
FE-1: Create and update accommodation listings	Fully Implemented	
FE-2: Search, filter and view accommodations	Fully Implemented	
FE-3: Calculate and display distances between properties and university locations	Fully Implemented	
FE-4: Reserve properties, track reservation status, and manage cancellations.	Fully Implemented	
FE-5: Alert relevant parties about new reservations, cancellations, and status changes.	Fully Implemented	
FE-6: Allow students to evaluate accommodations after their tenancy period.	Fully Implemented	
FE-7: API endpoints for authentication, property data, and reservation management.	Fully Implemented	
FE-8: Include the other two universities, HKUST and CUHK, to the Unihaven system.		Fully implemented

4.2 Release Plan

Release 1: Sprint 1 (March 20 - April 2, 2025)	Release 1: Sprint 2 (April 3 - April 16, 2025)	Release 2: Sprint 3 (April 17 - April 30, 2025)
Property database	Reservation management system	API endpoints for HKUST and CUHK
Search and filter system	Notification system	
Distance calculation system	Rating system	
API core endpoints	API remaining endpoints	